



Aussie support

Servicemen of the Royal Australian Air Force arrive at Tan Son Nhut airbase near Saigon on August 10, 1964. More than 60,000 Australian soldiers fought in the Vietnam War from 1962 through the end of 1972.

Australian troops

The Australian government was fully committed to Johnson's policy. Australia's first commitment of military advisers to train the ARVN in 1962 was escalated in 1965 to include combat troops, namely the First Battalion, Royal Australian Regiment, and logistics personnel attached to the United States' 173rd Airborne Brigade. This collaboration revealed major differences in US and Australian operational methods, so later deployments of Australian forces involved only independent operations. Australian troops relied less on heavy firepower and more on small patrols, setting ambushes, and cultivating positive relations with local civilians through civic action. Some 60,000 Australians fought in Vietnam, with about 500 killed and 3,000 wounded by war's end.